

# Printer & Peripherals Troubleshooting Guide

Because it's always the printer

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## Printing Triage Order

- 1 Scope: one user, one printer, or everyone? Everyone = print server/spooler/driver deployment issue, not the device.
- 2 Device check: online status, panel errors, connectivity (ping it), supplies/jams.
- 3 Queue check: stuck jobs → clear queue; spooler crash pattern → almost always a bad driver; identify which driver via Event Viewer PrintService log.
- 4 Driver strategy: use the correct architecture driver, prefer manufacturer stable (not 'universal' when features fail; not model-specific betas); Type 4 vs Type 3 behavior differences on Windows.
- 5 Path check: direct IP vs shared queue — a mapped queue failure with working direct-IP print isolates the server side.

## Common Scenarios

| Symptom                       | Fix Path                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Print jobs vanish silently    | Wrong default printer / printing to offline queue; check job log; verify port IP still matches device (DHCP moved it → reserve the IP!)                                                                                           |
| Garbage/ASCII pages           | Driver language mismatch (PCL vs PS) — switch driver; or corrupted job at the front of queue: clear spooler files                                                                                                                 |
| Slow printing large PDFs      | Print as image option, memory on device, driver rendering mode (host vs device)                                                                                                                                                   |
| Scan-to-email broke           | Almost always auth change: SMTP settings vs M365 (basic auth retired) — use approved relay method per current Microsoft guidance (HVE/ACS or authenticated submission with app registration); verify with device firmware updated |
| Scan-to-folder broke          | SMB version mismatch after server hardening (SMBv1 disabled = old device can't connect → firmware update or intermediary), password rotation on scan service account, folder permissions                                          |
| Label/receipt printer offline | USB power management (disable selective suspend), correct port after Windows update re-enumeration, vendor utility conflicts                                                                                                      |

## Peripheral Standards

- Every network printer gets a DHCP reservation or documented static IP, recorded in BVT-OPS-026.
- Multifunction devices are computers: change default admin passwords, update firmware on onboarding, disable unused protocols (Telnet/FTP), and include them in the asset inventory.
- Docks and adapters: standardize models per client; firmware updates fix a shocking number of 'flaky monitor' tickets.

- End-of-life peripherals that force insecure protocols (SMBv1) are replacement candidates, not exception candidates — document via BVT-SEC-021 if client declines.